

Labelling Requirements for Ayurvedic, Siddha and Unani Drugs — Rule 161, Drugs and Cosmetics Rules

Ministry of AYUSH · Guideline · 2020

SECTION 1 — MANDATORY LABEL PARTICULARS

Rule 161 of the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules requires every container and package label of an ASU drug to display, among other particulars:

- The name of the drug as given in the relevant recognised pharmacopoeia, or, where not in a pharmacopoeia, the name under which it is sold, with the ingredients displayed in the label/insert.
- A list of ingredients, including quantity of each ingredient present (Ayurvedic Aushadhi Nirman Vidhi / formula reference where applicable).
- Net contents in terms of weight, volume, or number of units.
- Manufacturing licence number, batch/lot number, manufacturing date, and (where prescribed) expiry or "best before" date.
- Name and address of the manufacturer, and, if different, the marketer.
- Any special storage conditions and directions for use.
- A statement of any therapeutic claims must correspond to indications recognised for the formulation and must not exceed pharmacopoeial or licensed claims — unsubstantiated disease-cure claims are prohibited and separately regulated under the Drugs and Magic Remedies (Objectionable Advertisements) Act, 1954.

SECTION 2 — PROHIBITED REPRESENTATIONS

Labels and accompanying literature must not claim the product cures, mitigates, treats, or prevents scheduled diseases and disorders listed under the Drugs and Magic Remedies Act unless permitted under that Act's exceptions. Comparative or superiority claims against named competitor products are similarly restricted.

SECTION 3 — LANGUAGE AND LEGIBILITY

Label particulars must be in English or Hindi (Devanagari), or in the regional language of the state of manufacture in addition to English/Hindi, and must be legible, indelible, and prominently displayed.

SECTION 4 — PRACTICAL CHECKLIST FOR AYUSH BRAND OWNERS

1. Cross-check every therapeutic claim on packaging/marketing material against the formulation's licensed indications.
2. Confirm batch numbering and manufacturing-licence details are current before each print run.
3. Maintain records substantiating any "clinically tested" or similar claims, as these attract separate advertising-standards scrutiny.

DISCLAIMER: General summary for informational/demo purposes; verify current requirements against the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1945 (as amended).